

# Cārvāka — MCQ Solutions

## Option-specific explanations and examiner traps

Correct positions were independently randomized with the stable seed hash `b336ff98c68f8ee873eee90cedafb3eeaa5cbfcce3ff672ef9336e047c381f8e`. Explanations remain bound to option content after permutation.

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Page numbers are generated from the final layout. PDF bookmarks include finer subheadings.

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## BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

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### 32 original MCQs — 24 core diagnostics and 8 remedial error-targeting drills

**Answer placement:** each correct option was fixed independently, so the key sequence is unpatterned rather than rotated. Options are matched for length, specificity and grammar so that the answer cannot be spotted by shape alone. Every question carries four question-specific option explanations and one unique examiner trap.

### MCQ 1

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**Coverage cell:** The three names of the school

Consider the following statements.

1. *Lokāyata* is standardly explained as the doctrine of the ordinary world or of common people.
2. *Bārhaspatya* names the tradition of Bṛhaspati, whose attributed aphorisms survive as a complete work.
3. The derivations of *Cārvāka* from "to chew" or from "pleasant speech" are doxographical etymologies rather than settled history.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 2 and 3 only
- B. 1 and 2 only
- C. 1, 2 and 3
- D. 1 and 3 only

**Answer: D.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: it keeps the false survival claim in 2 while discarding the sound gloss of *Lokāyata* as the worldly or popular doctrine. - **B:** Incorrect: statement 2 promotes a founder legend into a surviving document, whereas the attributed *Bṛhaspati-sūtra* is lost and known only through quoted fragments. - **C:** Incorrect: including 2 converts a traditional founder attribution into textual proof and contradicts the school's central source problem. - **D:** Correct: 1 and 3 reproduce the two safe cautions — *Lokāyata* is the this-worldly or popular doctrine, and the *Cārvāka* etymologies are doxographers' explanations, not historical evidence.

**Examiner trap 1:** The *Bārhaspatya* label records who the tradition claims as founder; it never certifies that a complete *Cārvāka* scripture is available for quotation.

### MCQ 2

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**Coverage cell:** The exact sense of *Veda-rejecting (nāstika)*

In classical Sanskrit philosophical classification, Cārvāka is called *nāstika* chiefly because it

- A. denies the reality of the perceptible external world along with its material objects and processes
- B. rejects Vedic authority as the primary criterion, while denial of post-mortem existence supplies a secondary sense
- C. denies a creator God, this being the primary test that separates orthodox from unorthodox systems
- D. accepts the authority of the Vedas while rejecting only the ritual apparatus that has grown around them

**Answer: B.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: the school affirms the perceptible world emphatically; its denials fall only on what cannot in principle be perceived. - **B:** Correct: the primary criterion of *nāstika* is rejection of Vedic authority; denial of life after death is a genuine but secondary sense in which the school also qualifies. - **C:** Incorrect: non-theism cannot be the classifying test, because classical Sāṃkhya and Mīmāṃsā accept the Veda while not requiring a creator God. - **D:** Incorrect: the rejection reaches Vedic authority itself, not merely the ritual practices that authority sanctions.

**Examiner trap 2:** Translating *nāstika* flatly as "atheist" loses the Veda-authority criterion and wrongly makes non-theistic orthodox schools unorthodox.

## MCQ 3

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**Coverage cell:** The textual situation of the school

Which statement best describes the source position of Cārvāka philosophy?

- A. A complete *Bṛhaspati-sūtra* survives, accompanied by commentaries written within the materialist tradition itself.
- B. Nothing responsible can be said about the school, because every surviving witness to it is polemical and hostile.
- C. Mādhava's *Sarvadarśanasamgraha* is an authentic primary work composed by a Cārvāka teacher for his own school.
- D. No systematic primary materialist text survives, so reconstruction relies chiefly on convergent reports composed by philosophical opponents.

**Answer: D.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: the attributed sūtra tradition is lost, and only scattered aphorisms and verses quoted by other authors remain. - **B:** Incorrect: hostility restricts confidence but does not abolish it, because independent opponents converge on the same doctrinal core. - **C:** Incorrect: the *Sarvadarśanasamgraha* chapter is a Vedāntin compendium's presentation of an opponent, valuable but not Cārvāka scripture. - **D:** Correct: reconstruction rests on convergent hostile testimony, which is why claims should be framed as the standard doxographical reconstruction.

**Examiner trap 3:** Writing that the sources are hostile is only half the point; the mark comes from adding that convergence across independent opponents still fixes a recoverable core.

## MCQ 4

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**Coverage cell:** The correct use of Jayarāṣi Bhaṭṭa

In an answer on Cārvāka, the *Tattvopaplavasīṃha* of Jayarāṣi Bhaṭṭa is best used

- A. as a Nyāya refutation that attacks materialist epistemology from outside the tradition it describes, and therefore as hostile testimony of the ordinary doxographical kind
- B. as the surviving work commonly associated with the tradition and a contested sceptical limit-case that attacks even definitions of perception
- C. as the primary text that positively establishes perception as the sole independent means of valid knowledge, supplying the school with the systematic treatise it otherwise lacks
- D. as a Mīmāṃsā defence of the intrinsic authority of the Veda, written to protect ritual obligation against the epistemological criticisms pressed by the materialists

**Answer: B.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: he is not a Naiyāyika; his dialectic dissolves Nyāya definitions rather than defending them. - **B:** Correct: he is the single surviving text-witness and simultaneously the internal limit-case, which is why his affiliation is discussed cautiously rather than assumed. - **C:** Incorrect: Jayarāṣi challenges the definability of perception as a means of valid knowledge, so he cannot be quoted to establish the school's defining thesis. - **D:** Incorrect: nothing in the work defends Vedic authority; his method is destructive of all definitional claims, orthodox and unorthodox alike.

**Examiner trap 4:** Using Jayarāṣi to state Cārvāka epistemology destroys the very thesis — perception alone is valid — that the standard school is defined by.

## MCQ 5

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**Coverage cell:** Why perception alone is admitted

The Cārvāka argument for restricting valid knowledge to perception proceeds by showing that

- A. perception is incapable of error, so no further source is needed to correct or supplement its deliverances at any point
- B. inference is acceptable while testimony is not, leaving perception and inference as the only two admissible independent sources of knowledge
- C. every cognition is fundamentally verbal, so perception must be treated as prior to the language in which knowledge is expressed
- D. inference exceeds what is immediately given, while testimony depends on inferred confidence in a speaker and therefore lacks independence

**Answer: D.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: infallibility is not claimed; indeed the perceptual illusion counter-argument is later pressed against the school by its critics. - **B:** Incorrect: it concedes exactly what the school denies, since the rejection of inference as an independent source is the school's most famous thesis. - **C:** Incorrect: this is a thesis about language, not the epistemic-economy argument that actually generates the perception-only rule. - **D:** Correct: this is the two-step economy — only perception presents its object immediately, and every rival source is either derivative or unproved.

**Examiner trap 5:** The thesis is that perception is the *only independent* means of valid knowledge, which is far stronger than the uncontroversial claim that perception is the *primary* one.

## MCQ 6

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**Coverage cell:** Whether consciousness is denied

The statement "Cārvāka denies consciousness" is

- A. incorrect, because the school treats consciousness as an eternal quality inhering in a substance distinct from the living body
- B. correct, because consciousness is not one of the four admitted elements and therefore has no place in the ontology
- C. incorrect, because pleasure, pain and desire are internally perceived while an imperceptible bearer distinct from the living body is denied
- D. correct, because only externally perceived material objects are admitted as belonging to the perceptible world

**Answer: C.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: an eternal quality inhering in a separate substance is precisely the Nyāya position the school is attacking. - **B:** Incorrect: consciousness is explained as a property of the organised elemental body, not eliminated from the world. - **C:** Correct: the school accepts the occurrence of awareness and rejects only the inferential addition of an immaterial possessor of it. - **D:** Incorrect: internal or mental perception of conscious states is expressly admitted alongside external perception.

**Examiner trap 6:** Denying a transcendental self is not denying awareness; scripts that merge the two lose the school's actual position on internal perception.

## MCQ 7

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**Coverage cell:** The attack on invariable concomitance

The central Cārvāka objection to inference is that invariable concomitance cannot be established because

- A. no inference has ever been observed to succeed, so the practice has no record of reliability to appeal to

- B. universals do not exist, so no relation obtaining between two universals can be stated or known in the first place
- C. finite perception cannot establish universal *vyāpti*, inference would be circular or regressive, and testimony has no independently proved authority
- D. the probans and the probandum are never in fact observed together, so no concomitance is available for generalisation at all

**Answer: C.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: the school concedes that inferences often succeed and argues instead that success is accidental rather than warranting. - **B:** Incorrect: denying universals is a Buddhist strategy; the Cārvāka objection is epistemic, about how the relation could be known. - **C:** Correct: this is the three-doors argument, and stating it as three closed routes rather than a vague "cannot be proved" is what earns marks. - **D:** Incorrect: the co-observation of smoke and fire is granted; the dispute concerns the leap from finite co-observation to an unrestricted universal.

**Examiner trap 7:** Reducing three distinct closed routes to one sentence about uncertainty is the commonest way of throwing away the marks in this argument.

## MCQ 8

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**Coverage cell:** The hidden limiting condition

The *hidden limiting condition (upādhi)* argument establishes that

- A. observed constancy may depend on an unnoticed condition and therefore fail to be unconditional
- B. universal relations become secure automatically once a sufficiently large number of positive instances is collected
- C. inference must be rejected because the conclusion drawn from a general rule is invariably found to be false
- D. a decisive counter-instance has already been observed against every universal that has so far been proposed

**Answer: A.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Correct: the wet-fuel qualification shows that what looked like a bare universal may have been conditioned all along. - **B:** Incorrect: this is the position under attack, since accumulation of positive cases is exactly what the objection says is insufficient. - **C:** Incorrect: falsity of conclusions is not asserted, and many inferences are admitted to reach true conclusions accidentally. - **D:** Incorrect: no such empirical claim is made; the argument is about what observation can guarantee, not about actual refutations.

**Examiner trap 8:** This is a structural objection about unnoticed qualifiers, not a complaint that too few instances have been counted.

## MCQ 9

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**Coverage cell:** Why verbal testimony is refused

Verbal testimony is denied the status of an independent means of valid knowledge because

- A. moving from an utterance to its truth requires inferred confidence in the speaker's competence and honesty, which words cannot certify
- B. words are conventional signs and therefore convey no determinate meaning that could be true or false at all
- C. the Veda is held to be authorless, and an authorless composition can carry no intelligible content for a hearer
- D. language is incapable of guiding practical action, so nothing said can ever be acted upon by a rational agent

**Answer: A.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Correct: testimony collapses into inference plus trust, so it cannot be rescued once inference has been denied independent validity. - **B:** Incorrect: meaning is not denied; the school accepts ordinary communication and denies only its independent epistemic warrant. - **C:** Incorrect: authorlessness is rejected as unproved, not treated as a source of unintelligibility. - **D:** Incorrect: pragmatic reliance on what people say is conceded; usefulness is separated from the status of a means of valid knowledge.

**Examiner trap 9:** Rejecting testimony as a means of valid knowledge is not rejecting language, and a script that confuses the two invites the charge of caricature.

## MCQ 10

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**Coverage cell:** Comparison, postulation and non-cognition

Applying the Cārvāka criterion to comparison (*upamāna*), postulation (*arthāpatti*) and non-cognition (*anupalabdhī*) yields which result?

- A. All three survive as independent sources, because none of them depends on the universal relation that inference presupposes and each rests on a distinct cognitive act.
- B. All three survive as independent sources, because each of them terminates directly in a fresh perceptual presentation of the object whose knowledge is being claimed.
- C. Each either presents only what perception already delivers, adding nothing independent, or moves beyond perception through an unproved universal and inherits the objection to inference.
- D. Only non-cognition survives, because the absence of an object is itself given directly in a single act of perception without any conditional reasoning being required.

**Answer: C.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: postulation excludes alternatives by a general rule and non-cognition uses a universal conditional, so both do depend on the disputed move. - **B:** Incorrect: if they terminated in perception they would add nothing independent, which is the first half of the dilemma rather than an escape from it. - **C:** Correct: the dilemma is exhaustive, though this systematic extension is a reconstruction rather than a claim that a surviving Cārvāka text refutes each later category by name. - **D:** Incorrect: "if the object were here it would be perceived" is a universal conditional, not the content of one perception.

**Examiner trap 10:** Present the extension to the larger catalogue as systematic reconstruction; asserting that a surviving Cārvāka work separately refuted each later category is unsupported.

## MCQ 11

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**Coverage cell:** How Nyāya rebuilds concomitance

Which set correctly lists the Nyāya devices for establishing invariable concomitance?

- A. Scriptural authority, the intuition of the accomplished yogin, and the reported statement of a person accepted as reliable by the community
- B. An exhaustive enumeration of every past, present and future instance, secured by a survey that no finite observer has yet completed
- C. The postulation of an unseen moral force that guarantees the stability of the regularity across all the cases not yet examined
- D. Agreement in presence and absence, removal of suspected conditions, supportive *tarka*, and later Nyāya perception of universal characters

**Answer: D.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: scripture and yogic intuition are not the Nyāya route to concomitance, which is built from ordinary observation and reasoning. - **B:** Incorrect: complete enumeration is the impossible standard the Cārvāka demands, and Nyāya's reply consists precisely in abandoning it. - **C:** Incorrect: an unseen moral force is a Mīmāṃsā-style postulate and would concede the Cārvāka charge that the universal rests on the imperceptible. - **D:** Correct: positive and negative correlation, elimination of suspected conditions and supportive reasoning replace omniscient survey with disciplined procedure.

**Examiner trap 11:** Supportive reasoning is not itself a means of valid knowledge; it removes doubt and cannot by itself establish the relation, and saying so keeps the answer balanced.

## MCQ 12

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**Coverage cell:** The self-refutation charge

The charge of self-refutation against Cārvāka is most precisely stated as follows.

- A. A materialist cannot live consistently, because the necessities of eating, drinking and social life already presuppose a moral order.

- B. The universal denial of inference is not delivered by one perception, so defending that denial appears to require the reasoning rejected.
- C. The rejection of the Veda is inconsistent, because the very Sanskrit in which the rejection is stated is a Vedic inheritance.
- D. The ethics of pleasure contradicts the metaphysics of four elements, because pleasure is not itself an element in that list.

**Answer: B.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: this is a practical taunt, not the internal inconsistency that makes the philosophical charge severe. - **B:** Correct: the thesis quantifies over all inferential acts, and universality is exactly what perception alone cannot supply. - **C:** Incorrect: a linguistic genealogy establishes nothing about the epistemic status of the doctrine being asserted. - **D:** Incorrect: pleasure is treated as a state of the organised body, so no contradiction with the elemental ontology arises here.

**Examiner trap 12:** The charge is that the position is internally unstable, which is far stronger than the familiar and much weaker complaint that it is impractical.

## MCQ 13

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**Coverage cell:** Practical inference and accidental truth

Which formulation best preserves the refined Cārvāka position on everyday inference?

- A. Everyday inference must be surrendered together with all reasoning about what is absent, since a consistent materialist can appeal to nothing whatever beyond present sensation.
- B. Everyday inference establishes unseen entities whenever it succeeds repeatedly, so accumulated success gradually converts a practical habit into demonstrative and certain knowledge.
- C. Worldly inference is a corrigible expectation answerable to later perception, whereas transcendence-bearing inference lacks any possible perceptual check.
- D. Everyday inference is a genuine means of valid knowledge in worldly matters, while inference employed in scriptural argument alone is disqualified as invalid and unwarranted.

**Answer: C.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: this is the caricature the refined reading is designed to avoid, and it makes ordinary life unintelligible. - **B:** Incorrect: accumulating success is habit-formation, and the school's whole point is that habit never matures into certainty. - **C:** Correct: this keeps action possible, locates the real target in unredeemable inference, and blocks the appeal to predictive success. - **D:** Incorrect: granting the status of a means of valid knowledge in one domain surrenders the thesis, since status is not domain-relative.

**Examiner trap 13:** The distinction between practical usability and the status of a means of valid knowledge is the hinge of the refined reading; omitting it makes the answer look naïve.

## MCQ 14

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**Coverage cell:** Where Cārvāka sits in the ledger of knowledge sources

Arranged by the number of independent means of valid knowledge admitted, which sequence is correct?

- A. Cārvāka one · Nyāya two · Sāṃkhya four · Advaita three, with testimony counted only where scripture is decisive
- B. All classical schools admit exactly three, differing only in the names they give to those three sources
- C. Cārvāka one · Vaiśeṣika and Buddhism two · Sāṃkhya-Yoga three · Nyāya four · Prābhākara Mīmāṃsā five · Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsā and Advaita six
- D. Cārvāka two · Nyāya three · Mīmāṃsā four · Advaita five, with comparison counted only inside the Mīmāṃsā tradition

**Answer: C.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: Sāṃkhya admits perception, inference and testimony, and Advaita is placed above Nyāya, not below it. - **B:** Incorrect: the number of admitted sources is precisely what the schools dispute, from one up to six. - **C:** Correct: Cārvāka occupies the lower bound of a shared ledger, which is why every richer epistemology must justify its additions against it. - **D:** Incorrect: it credits Cārvāka with two sources and understates Advaita, which is standardly assigned the fullest list.

**Examiner trap 14:** Presenting Cārvāka as an eccentric outlier misses the structural point that it fixes the minimum against which every other school defends its additions.

## MCQ 15

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**Coverage cell:** The elemental scheme

Which statement about the Cārvāka account of the elements is correct?

- A. Earth, water, fire and air are admitted as perceptible elements, while *ākāśa* is rejected because its alleged substrate-role is inferred.
- B. Three elements are accepted, since air is treated as a rarefied condition of fire and water rather than as an independent element with a sensible quality of its own.
- C. Four elements are accepted and *ākāśa* is retained as a non-substantial medium that accommodates bodies without itself counting as one of the material elements.
- D. Five elements are accepted, including *ākāśa*, because the perception of sound requires an imperceptible substratum in which the quality of sound can inhere.

**Answer: A.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Correct: the fourfold scheme follows from the criterion, and refusing an imperceptible substratum for sound is the reason usually given. - **B:** Incorrect: no reduction of air is reported; the disputed element is *ākāśa*, and the count in question is four against five. - **C:** Incorrect:

retaining *ākāśa* in any form readmits an imperceptible item that the criterion excludes. - **D:** Incorrect: this is the Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika inference, and it is exactly the move the perceptual criterion disallows.

**Examiner trap 15:** Writing "five elements" is the single most punished factual slip in this topic, because five is the standard number in most other Indian systems.

## MCQ 16

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**Coverage cell:** Evidence for the body-self

Which evidence is characteristically used to identify the self with the living body?

- A. First-person bodily predicates such as being stout or thin, together with the absence of any separately perceived self, support the body-self.
- B. A subtle body is perceived departing at the moment of death, which shows that personhood is exhausted by material organisation.
- C. Scriptural passages are cited in which the self is expressly identified with the gross body rather than with an inner controller.
- D. Memory-continuity is inferred to require a persisting substance, and that substance is then identified with the physical organism.

**Answer: A.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Correct: identity-language plus the absence of any separately encountered self supplies a perceptual, non-inferential case for the body-self. - **B:** Incorrect: no such perception is claimed, and a departing subtle body would concede survival after death. - **C:** Incorrect: scriptural support would be self-defeating for a school that denies testimony the status of a means of valid knowledge. - **D:** Incorrect: this argues from an inference, whereas the school's strength here is its refusal to add an unperceived bearer.

**Examiner trap 16:** The opponent's reply that "my body" separates possessor from possessed must be met by noting that possessive grammar does not by itself prove a separate substance.

## MCQ 17

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**Coverage cell:** The betel and fermentation analogies

The betel and fermentation analogies are offered in order to show that

- A. consciousness is identical with one of the four elements taken singly, most often with the element of fire in the living body
- B. consciousness is an eternal quality of a separate self that the body merely manifests when the sense organs are in working order
- C. the elements are severally conscious already, though their consciousness remains unnoticed until they enter a bodily combination

D. an organised combination can display a novel property absent from its separate ingredients, so awareness need not require an immaterial bearer

**Answer: D.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: the analogies work precisely because the novel property belongs to none of the ingredients taken singly. - **B:** Incorrect: manifestation of a pre-existing quality is the rival account that the emergence claim is designed to replace. - **C:** Incorrect: attributing latent consciousness to each element abandons emergence and concedes a form of panpsychism. - **D:** Correct: red colour from betel ingredients and intoxicating power from fermenting agents illustrate emergent properties of an organised whole.

**Examiner trap 17:** The honest qualification is that emergence is asserted rather than explained, since redness and intoxicating power are third-personal while awareness is first-personal.

## MCQ 18

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**Coverage cell:** The four materialist identifications of the self

Sadānanda's *Vedāntasāra* reports four materialist positions distinguished by what each takes the self to be. Which set is correct?

- A. Gross body, subtle body, causal body and the witnessing consciousness that underlies all three of them
- B. The body, the intellect, the store of past actions and the liberated condition attained after their exhaustion
- C. Gross body, the sense faculties, the vital processes, and the internal mental organ
- D. The body, the accumulated moral residue, memory, and the desire that binds a person to future births

**Answer: C.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: this is the Vedāntic sheath-and-witness scheme, which posits exactly the transcendent principle materialists reject. - **B:** Incorrect: moral residue and liberation are among the entities the school denies, so they cannot appear as materialist candidates. - **C:** Correct: body, senses, vital processes and mind exhaust the reported list, and each candidate perishes with the living complex. - **D:** Incorrect: it imports rebirth-machinery into a taxonomy whose whole point is that no candidate survives bodily dissolution.

**Examiner trap 18:** This fourfold list classifies the proposed bearer of personhood and must not be confused with the later crude-versus-refined contrast between types of Cārvāka.

## MCQ 19

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**Coverage cell:** The denial of transcendent entities

The opponent-preserved formula "death itself is liberation" is best read as

- A. a verse from surviving Cārvāka scripture that formally defines liberation for the materialist school

- B. a positive description of a blissful post-mortem condition attained once the body has been dissolved
- C. a denial of any positive release: bodily dissolution ends the person and therefore ends experienced suffering
- D. a claim that liberation is produced by the correct performance of funerary ritual at the moment of death

**Answer: C.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: the formula is preserved by opponents, and no Cārvāka scripture survives from which it could be quoted. - **B:** Incorrect: any positive post-mortem state would reinstate the survival the school denies on perceptual grounds. - **C:** Correct: the phrase is deflationary, cancelling the goal rather than describing an attainment. - **D:** Incorrect: the school's ritual critique is directed against exactly this kind of claim about unseen ritual results.

**Examiner trap 19:** Quoting the formula as a Cārvāka definition of liberation reverses its sense, since it abolishes the category instead of filling it.

## MCQ 20

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**Coverage cell:** Own-nature and accidentalism

Which statement correctly distinguishes explanation by own-nature (*svabhāvavāda*) from accidentalism (*yadr̥cchāvāda*)?

- A. Explanation by own-nature rejects transcendent causation while preserving natural regularity, whereas accidentalism denies determinate causation and is contestably attributed.
- B. Both are orthodox doctrines about an unseen causal order which the materialists rejected in favour of a purely perceptual account of how natural processes come about.
- C. Both deny causation entirely, so the two terms are interchangeable labels for a single Cārvāka doctrine about the natural world and the regularities that are observed in it.
- D. Explanation by own-nature denies all causation, while accidentalism preserves observed regularity by grounding it in chance conjunctions among the four admitted material elements.

**Answer: A.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Correct: thorn-sharpness and the peacock's colours illustrate real regularities explained immanently, whereas accidentalism dissolves determinate causation. - **B:** Incorrect: neither is an orthodox doctrine, and accidentalism is criticised by Buddhists, Jainas and Naiyāyikas alike. - **C:** Incorrect: own-nature explanation retains causation and merely refuses to ground it in an unseen moral or divine order. - **D:** Incorrect: the two positions are reversed, since it is accidentalism, not own-nature, that abandons determinate causation.

**Examiner trap 20:** Attribute own-nature explanation to Cārvāka as its mainstream principle, and flag the accidentalist association as contested rather than asserting it.

## MCQ 21

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**Coverage cell:** The structure of Cārvāka ethics

Which statement best expresses the ethical position of the school?

- A. Duty grounded in scripture is retained as a social necessity while liberation alone is rejected as an unverifiable transcendent goal.
- B. Immediate gratification is to be maximised without any weighing of consequence, since consequences lie in a future that cannot be perceived now.
- C. Pleasure and wealth are co-equal ultimate ends of human life, and neither is subordinate to the other in the ordering of goods.
- D. Pleasure is the end and wealth its instrument, while foreseeable pain calls for prudent selection rather than renunciation of embodied enjoyment.

**Answer: D.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: scripturally grounded duty is rejected along with liberation, since both rest on the sources already denied. - **B:** Incorrect: reckless indulgence is the hostile caricature, and the reported incorporation of statecraft and economics tells against it. - **C:** Incorrect: the two are expressly ranked, wealth being valuable only in so far as it sustains enjoyment. - **D:** Correct: this is prudential hedonism, and the husk-and-grain image is the standard reply to the objection that pleasure always carries pain.

**Examiner trap 21:** The reported inclusion of statecraft and livelihood in the Lokāyata curriculum is thin doxographical evidence; present it as suggestive of a secular social theory, not as established.

## MCQ 22

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**Coverage cell:** Cārvāka and the Jaina conception of reality

Which contrast between the two conceptions of reality is accurate?

- A. Cārvāka admits perceptible material particulars, whereas Jainism admits enduring plural substances described through standpoint-conditioned and many-sided predication.
- B. Cārvāka admits plural substances including souls, while Jainism reduces all reality to a single conscious principle that appears as many.
- C. Both restrict reality to matter, differing only over whether the number of material elements is four or five.
- D. Both accept an unchanging reality behind appearances, differing only over whether that reality can be known by perception.

**Answer: A.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Correct: the contrast runs through the means of knowledge, substance, self and liberation, not merely through the slogan of matter against spirit. - **B:** Incorrect: the positions are inverted, since souls are plural in Jainism and denied altogether in Cārvāka. - **C:** Incorrect: Jaina reality includes conscious substance, so the disagreement is not a dispute about counting elements. - **D:** Incorrect: Cārvāka posits no reality behind appearances, and Jaina persistence-through-change is not an unchanging substratum.

**Examiner trap 22:** Reducing this comparison to "materialism versus spiritualism" forfeits the marks that come from arguing it across knowledge, substance, self and liberation.

## MCQ 23

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**Coverage cell:** Whether the school is positivistic

Which is the strongest reason for qualifying the label "positivistic" when it is applied to Cārvāka?

- A. Cārvāka accepts scriptural testimony in a restricted practical form, whereas positivism excludes revelation altogether from the domain of statements that can count as knowledge.
- B. Positivism depends on scientific inference and law-like explanation, whereas Cārvāka denies inference the status of a means of valid knowledge, so a shared anti-metaphysical spirit conceals opposite methods.
- C. The term is modern and Western, so any comparison between it and a classical Indian school is illegitimate in principle and can only distort both sides of the comparison.
- D. Positivism admits an immaterial self as the subject of experience, whereas Cārvāka identifies the person with the living body and allows no bearer beyond it.

**Answer: B.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: scriptural testimony is rejected outright, so this cannot be the point of divergence. - **B:** Correct: the agreement is about what may be admitted, and the disagreement is about the very inferential machinery on which science runs. - **C:** Incorrect: controlled comparison is legitimate and is even used in the standard expositions, provided it is offered as analogy rather than identity. - **D:** Incorrect: positivism does not require an immaterial self, so this supposed contrast does not exist.

**Examiner trap 23:** A flat yes or a flat no both lose marks here; the demand invites a graded verdict that concedes the empiricist temper and refuses the inferential identification.

## MCQ 24

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**Coverage cell:** Two refusals of the self

Which statement correctly differentiates the Cārvāka refusal of a transcendental self from the Buddhist rejection of a self?

- A. Cārvāka denies the self while Buddhism affirms an eternal self that survives the dissolution of the aggregates at death and carries the moral record forward into a further life.

B. Both denials are identical in content and differ only in the technical vocabulary that each tradition happens to employ when it states its rejection of an enduring self.

C. Cārvāka denies transcendence but keeps a material bearer, whereas Buddhism denies substantiality, retains causal continuity, and rejects material form as self.

D. Buddhism identifies the person with the physical body while Cārvāka denies that any bearer of personhood exists at all, whether that bearer is conceived as material or as immaterial.

**Answer: C.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: an eternal self is exactly what the Buddhist doctrine of not-self is formulated to reject. - **B:** Incorrect: the two denials rest on different arguments and yield different consequences for rebirth and moral continuity. - **C:** Correct: the Buddhist analysis is wider, not weaker, because it dismantles the very identification the Cārvāka retains. - **D:** Incorrect: the positions are reversed, since it is Cārvāka that keeps a bearer and makes it material.

**Examiner trap 24:** Writing that both schools "deny the self in the same way" collapses a twenty-mark comparison into a one-line similarity and cannot recover the marks.

## MCQ 25

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**Coverage cell:** Remedial drill — what exactly is denied about awareness

Which claim about awareness is actually held by the school?

A. Awareness is identical with the element of air, which circulates through the body and animates its organs.

B. Awareness does not occur at all, since nothing beyond the four elements is admitted into the account of the world.

C. Awareness is an eternal quality inhering in an immaterial self that uses the body as its temporary instrument.

D. Awareness occurs and is internally perceived, but no imperceptible bearer of it follows from that occurrence.

**Answer: D.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: identification with a single element is ruled out by the emergence account, in which no ingredient carries the property alone. - **B:** Incorrect: eliminating awareness would contradict internal perception, which the school expressly admits. - **C:** Incorrect: this is the Nyāya account of the self and its qualities, which the school is arguing against. - **D:** Correct: the occurrence is granted and only the inferential addition of a possessor is refused.

**Examiner trap 25:** The frequent slip is to move from "no soul" to "no consciousness"; the school's position lies precisely between those two claims.

## MCQ 26

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**Coverage cell:** Remedial drill — rejecting inference and never inferring

A script states: "Because Cārvāka rejects inference, a Cārvāka never reasons from smoke to fire in ordinary life." The error is that

- A. the school in fact accepts inference as a fully independent means of valid knowledge alongside perception
- B. the school denies perception as well, so no example drawn from ordinary observation can illustrate its position
- C. Inference loses independent *pramāṇa* status, not its practical role in moving fallibly from a perceived sign toward what it signifies.
- D. reasoning from smoke to fire counts as testimony rather than inference, so the example is misclassified from the start

**Answer: C.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: granting independent validity would surrender the school's most characteristic thesis. - **B:** Incorrect: perception is the one source that is affirmed, so the premise of this option is false. - **C:** Correct: practical movement from sign to signified is conceded as corrigible habit answerable to later perception. - **D:** Incorrect: smoke-to-fire is the standard textbook example of inference, not of testimony.

**Examiner trap 26:** Confusing a claim about epistemic status with a claim about behaviour makes the school look absurd and invites the examiner's charge of caricature.

## MCQ 27

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**Coverage cell:** Remedial drill — own-nature against unseen moral force

"Fire burns by its own nature" differs from "fire burns because of an unseen moral factor" because

- A. both statements appeal to transcendent causation and differ only in the vocabulary that each of them happens to choose for the cause
- B. The first ends explanation with an observable natural property, while the second adds an imperceptible moral force beyond the perceptual criterion.
- C. the first appeals to divine will while the second appeals to an impersonal physical law that governs combustion wherever it occurs
- D. the first denies that any regularity obtains in nature, whereas the second affirms regularity and offers an account of its stability

**Answer: B.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: only the second appeals to something transcendent; the first is deliberately immanent. - **B:** Correct: the contrast is between an immanent stopping point and a supersensible postulate. - **C:** Incorrect: divine will belongs to neither, and the unseen moral factor is not an impersonal physical law. - **D:** Incorrect: regularity is affirmed by own-nature explanation, which is what separates it from accidentalism.

**Examiner trap 27:** Concede the fair objection that "by its own nature" can look like a placeholder, then answer it by noting that every explanatory chain terminates somewhere and this terminus is at least observable.

## MCQ 28

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**Coverage cell:** Remedial drill — two different objections to a universal

Consider two objections to a proposed universal relation: (i) not every case has been observed; (ii) the observed cases may have shared an unnoticed further condition. Which is the hidden-limiting-condition objection, and why does the difference matter?

- A. Objection (ii), because it survives however extensive the observation becomes, showing that constancy of observation cannot certify unconditionality
- B. Objection (i), because a hidden limiting condition is simply another name for an incomplete survey of the available instances
- C. Both, because the two objections restate a single complaint about the finitude of human observation in different words
- D. Neither, because the hidden limiting condition concerns the formal validity of the syllogism rather than the truth of its premise

**Answer: A.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Correct: incompleteness is quantitative and could in principle be reduced, whereas an unnoticed qualifier defeats the universal itself. - **B:** Incorrect: this collapses the sharper objection into the weaker one and loses what makes the argument structural. - **C:** Incorrect: the two differ in kind, since only one of them concerns the content of the supposed relation. - **D:** Incorrect: formal validity is expressly conceded in the school's treatment of the standard syllogism.

**Examiner trap 28:** Stating only the incomplete-survey point leaves the strongest half of the case unwritten, because the qualifier objection is what defeats unconditionality.

## MCQ 29

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**Coverage cell:** Remedial drill — the crude and refined contrast

How should the crude and refined (*dhūrta* and *suśikṣita*) contrast be used in an answer?

- A. As another name for the fourfold taxonomy of materialist identifications of the self that Vedāntic sources report and classify

- B. as an opponent-preserved crude/refined contrast whose refined form supplies a possible response to the charge of practical self-refutation
- C. As a modern scholarly invention with no basis in the Indian doxographical literature through which the school has been transmitted
- D. As two securely attested Cārvāka schools with surviving texts, named teachers and datable institutional histories running in parallel

**Answer: B.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: that taxonomy classifies the bearer of personhood, a different question altogether. - **B:** Correct: the safe formula is that later doxographers distinguish a crude from a refined form, though the evidence is indirect. - **C:** Incorrect: the contrast is genuinely reported in the doxographical literature, even though it is transmitted by opponents. - **D:** Incorrect: no surviving Cārvāka text confirms two schools with fixed doctrines, and the labels vary across doxographies.

**Examiner trap 29:** Over-documenting this contrast as institutional history is as damaging as ignoring it, because the source base cannot carry that weight.

## MCQ 30

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**Coverage cell:** Remedial drill — what survives of the attributed aphorisms

What survives of the aphorisms attributed to Bṛhaspati?

- A. Nothing whatever, so that not even a single quoted line can be attributed to the tradition with any confidence
- B. No continuous primary text survives, but scattered aphorisms and verses remain in works that usually quote them while mounting refutations.
- C. The complete work, together with at least one commentary composed within the materialist tradition itself
- D. A condensed summary chapter, written by a Cārvāka author for the instruction of students of the school

**Answer: B.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: quoted fragments do survive, and denying them overstates the loss and paralyses the answer. - **B:** Correct: about a dozen aphorisms and verses are quoted by others, which is why reconstruction is cautious but not impossible. - **C:** Incorrect: no such work or commentary is extant, which is the root of the school's reconstruction problem. - **D:** Incorrect: the well-known summary chapter is by a Vedāntin compiler presenting an opponent's view.

**Examiner trap 30:** Both overstatements fail here — claiming a surviving treatise, and claiming that nothing at all survives.

## MCQ 31

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**Coverage cell:** Remedial drill — the status of the pleasure verse

How should the verse "as long as one lives, let one live happily", with the associated line about incurring debt, be handled in an answer?

- A. As a word-for-word quotation from the surviving aphorisms of Bṛhaspati, and therefore as decisive documentary evidence
- B. As the school's official ethical formula, sufficient on its own to describe the whole of Cārvāka moral philosophy
- C. as a traditional doxographical verse associated with the school, not as a quotation secured by an extant Cārvāka primary text
- D. As a Mīmāṃsā parody of materialism with no genuine connection to the Lokāyata tradition at any point

**Answer: C.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: no extant primary text exists from which a verbatim quotation could be taken. - **B:** Incorrect: treating a slogan as the complete ethics reproduces the caricature that the refined reading exists to correct. - **C:** Correct: the verse may be used for colour and framing provided its transmission status is stated honestly. - **D:** Incorrect: the verse is genuinely transmitted in association with the tradition, even though its provenance is doxographical.

**Examiner trap 31:** Quoting the verse is safe; presenting it as scripture, or as the school's entire ethical theory, is not.

## MCQ 32

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**Coverage cell:** Remedial drill — placing the sceptical wing

Which use of Jayarāśi in an answer is defensible?

- A. Presenting him as a Naiyāyika author who refuted the materialists from a standpoint outside their tradition
- B. Quoting him to establish that perception alone is the school's single independent means of valid knowledge
- C. Treating him as proof that all Cārvākas denied the existence of the four elements they are otherwise reported to accept
- D. as a contested sceptical wing whose destructive dialectic attacks every positive *pramāṇa* definition without straightforwardly asserting standard materialism

**Answer: D.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: he is not a Naiyāyika, and his dialectic dismantles Nyāya definitions rather than deploying them. - **B:** Incorrect: his argument turns against the definability of perception itself, so he cannot certify the standard thesis. - **C:** Incorrect: generalising a limit-case to the whole tradition contradicts the convergent reports of four-element materialism. - **D:** Correct: he supplies the strongest answer to the self-refutation charge precisely because a purely destructive dialectic asserts no rival thesis.

**Examiner trap 32:** Even a purely destructive dialectic may covertly assume that destructive reasoning is reliable, and conceding that residual worry strengthens rather than weakens the answer.